Technological Innovation and Operational Excellence

Streamlining Data Management

In Pennsylvania's business world, a company emerged as a beacon of hope for the often-overlooked minority vendors. With a team of tenacious professionals and an impressive revenue of $1 million, the company stood at a pivotal crossroads. Their mission was noble yet fraught with challenges: connecting sprawling construction projects with capable local minority vendors, fostering diversity and inclusion in a sector that desperately needed it.

Yet, the path to achieving this noble mission was ensnared in a web of data chaos. Vital information lay scattered across disparate realms – from the virtual confines of spreadsheets and HubSpot databases to the physical realms of business cards and documents. This fragmentation was more than a mere inconvenience; it was a formidable barrier, stifling their growth and clouding their vision of a more inclusive construction industry.

Recognizing the urgency for transformation, the company embarked on a journey that promised to be as transformative as it was daunting. They envisioned a future where data was not a hurdle but a catalyst – a future where questions could be asked and answered with the simplicity of typing into a box, thanks to the marvels of Natural Language Processing and Machine Learning. They dreamed of a single, unified cloud database, a beacon of clarity in their previously foggy data landscape.

This case study is a chronicle of this daring journey – a tale of technology, transformation, and triumph. It's about how a small company in Pennsylvania dared to dream big, weaving together the threads of technology and innovation to chart a new course in the construction industry. Herein lies a story of resilience,

ingenuity, and the relentless pursuit of a vision that would redefine the possibilities of data management and vendor connection in the construction world.

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Client Background

A Pennsylvania-based company needed a way to match minority vendors with construction projects. Their goal was straightforward: make it easier for large contractors to meet diversity requirements. But they were buried in spreadsheets, incomplete records, and no real system to track or automate outreach. Vendors were being overlooked. Opportunities missed. They needed a system that could keep up.

Challenges

Data Fragmentation

Vendor information was scattered—across Excel files, paper business cards, old directories, and a CRM (HubSpot) that wasn't built for matchmaking. Records were outdated, fields were misused, and no one trusted the data.

Manual Matching

There was no easy way to quickly pull a list of vendors who matched a project's requirements. Staff had to manually search, sort, and vet records—burning time on tasks that should've taken seconds.

Follow-Up Failures

Without automation, there were no reminders or prompts to re-engage vendors when new projects became available. Relationships went cold, and compliance slipped.

Bad Data

Importing vendor info often resulted in the wrong data landing in the wrong fields. Fixing it was a manual process, which led to mismatches and frustration.

Limited Outreach

No email automation meant vendors weren't kept in the loop. Construction firms had no efficient way to notify vendors of new opportunities.

Strategic Blind Spots

The company couldn't see the full picture. Decision-making was based on partial info. They couldn't act fast, and they couldn't scale.

Tech Limitations

Their tools couldn't handle the volume, the complexity, or the speed they needed. They were falling behind.

Approach

They deployed TODD. One platform. One database. One set of tools built to manage vendor relationships at scale.

Step one: load everything into Google Cloud—spreadsheets, CRM records, business cards, PDFs. TODD's enrichment engine cleaned, filled in missing data, and flagged bad entries.

Next, NLP search. No dropdowns or checkboxes. Staff could type "Who's certified in Philly?" and get a clean list instantly.

TODD's Matchmaker prioritized vendors based on contract requirements. Machine Learning made that matching smarter over time—factoring in experience, licenses, and past engagement.

Reconfigure cleaned up bad imports—automatically correcting misplaced names, emails, and profiles.

They also connected TODD to HubSpot via API. No more duplicate entries or syncing delays.

How TODD Transformed Vendor Engagement

1. Matching Vendors Instantly with TODD's Matchmaker

To solve the vendor matchmaking problem, TODD's Matchmaker feature let users:

✅ Enter company name, location, and contract criteria.

✅ Instantly get a list of businesses that fit the requirements.

✅ Filter results in real time by licensing, experience, or minority certifications.

Large businesses no longer needed days to compile lists—TODD gave them results in seconds.

2. Fixing Incomplete Vendor Data Automatically

TODD's Data Enrichment filled in the blanks:

🔷 Industry specialization

🔷 Certification status

🔷 Contact validation

Everything was updated behind the scenes, so businesses had the right data before being matched to a contract.

3. Cleaning Up Dirty Data with Reconfigure

Messy spreadsheets were fixed using TODD's Reconfigure feature:

🔷 Business names in the wrong column? Fixed.

🔷 Contact fields in the wrong spot? Fixed.

🔷 Entire record out of format? Rebuilt correctly.

No more manual cleanup. Just accurate records every time.

4. Never Miss a Touchpoint Again

To keep vendors engaged, TODD introduced automated follow-ups:

✅ Found vendors that had gone cold or had new opportunities.

✅ Sent outreach emails automatically.

✅ Alerted users when it was time to follow up.

This saved users from dropped balls and kept momentum going.

5. Typing “Who” Replaced Clicking Through Tabs

With TODD’s NLP search, users didn’t need to dig through filters or menus. They could just type:

💬 “Show me all drywall vendors in Pittsburgh.”

💬 “List vendors who worked on public contracts in the last two years.”

💬 “Which minority-owned construction companies are located within 50 miles?”

💬 “Who do I need to follow up with?” → The assistant replies: “Would you like me to navigate there now?”

Search went from frustrating to fast.

6. Assistant Confirmation Prevents Mistakes

The assistant didn’t just assume. It asked:

💬 “Got it — you want to update John Murphy’s email to john@example.com. Should I go ahead?”

💬 “Got it — you want to add Cecilia Gonzalez as a new lead. Should I go ahead?”

Users confirmed before anything changed. No more accidental updates.

7. Predictive Suggestions While Typing

The assistant helped users even before they finished typing. For example, typing “who” surfaced suggestions like:

🔷 “Who do I need to follow up with?”

🔷 “Who hasn’t responded to my last email?”

These came from real usage patterns, powered by OpenAI.

It guided users naturally—no help manual needed.

This guided users and reduced friction by offering common or useful query completions, especially for users unfamiliar with the system.

Partnerships or Collaborations

Two local firms joined the effort:

- A machine learning shop helped design the predictive models for vendor matching.
- An IT and training firm handled rollout, onboarding, and user training. No one got left behind.

Results and Impact

- Matchmaker cut vendor search time by 60%.
- NLP search reduced lookup time by 75%.
- Auto follow-ups increased engagement by 40%.
- Reconfigure slashed manual cleanup by 90%.
- Revenue doubled in one year.

Large firms met their diversity targets faster. Vendors got real opportunities. The company became the go-to platform for public-private vendor compliance.

Quantitative and Qualitative Data

Quantitative:

- 100% revenue growth
- 60% faster vendor matching
- 75% faster data retrieval
- 40% more vendor engagement
- 90% less manual cleanup

Qualitative:

- "*We finally had a system that let us win more business, not just track it.*"
- "*Contractors started trusting our data. Vendors started trusting our process.*"
- "*It used to take hours to find the right vendors. Now it takes seconds.*"
- "*We stopped managing spreadsheets and started building real relationships.*"

Insights on Best Practices

- **Automate Everything:** Matching, follow-ups, compliance reports—don't leave it to memory.
- **Keep Your Data Clean:** Use enrichment and reconfiguration tools so your info is actually usable.
- **Search Should Be Simple:** NLP is faster than filters and checkboxes.
- **Follow-Up or Fail:** Most vendors didn't respond the first time. Follow-ups changed that.
- **Partnerships Matter:** Bring in experts when you need them.

Lessons Learned

- Systems need to scale. Spreadsheets don't.
- A platform is only useful if people actually use it—training is not optional.
- You don't need more data. You need the right data, structured the right way.
- Don't ask users to adapt to the software. Make the software adapt to them.

Key Points Summarized

- The client replaced their patchwork tools with a single AI-powered platform.
- TODD unified data, automated tasks, and made vendor search and outreach simple.

- NLP, Machine Learning, and data reconfiguration made the system usable and accurate.
- Strategic partners helped with training and algorithm design.
- The company became faster, more compliant, and more profitable.

Conclusion

This wasn't a software deployment. It was a business overhaul. TODD became more than just a CRM or contact manager—it operated like a workforce. Vendor search, engagement, compliance tracking—all automated, all smarter. With better tools, cleaner data, and automation that works, this Pennsylvania firm went from behind the curve to leading the field. Anyone looking to work smarter—not just harder—should take note.